Canadian EPR and Circular Economy Landscape

Product epr
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Executive brief

- **NEW · Federal.** Budget 2026 proposes CAD 76 million over four fiscal years to renew plastics circularity work across three federal bodies. It also proposes Fisheries Act amendments on abandoned, lost or discarded fishing gear. Municipal funding eligibility and any new reporting requirements would need separate implementation details. Budget 2026, Chapter 4 · Annex 3
- **UPDATED · Ontario.** The oral registration cutoff for Bill 140 committee hearings fell on November 6. Written submissions are due November 17, and the separate Blue Box policy consultation closes November 26. The regulator's separate consultation on draft supply and audit guidance closes first, on November 16. Committee notice · Environmental Registry · RPRA consultation
- **NEW · British Columbia.** Salish Soils announced a Greater Vancouver expansion that uses existing partners and infrastructure. For buyers, the announcement adds a potential service option for eligible commercial materials. Verified receiving capacity and actual material destinations would need to be established for each contract. Salish Soils release
- **UPDATED · Alberta.** Calgary's November 10 commercial paint roundup was a scheduled stewardship event. The next advertised collection at Shepard Landfill is November 24, with a 1:45 p.m. material acceptance cutoff. Renue event · Shepard event

Regulatory developments

Federal · NEW budget proposal for plastics and fishing gear

Finance Canada tabled Budget 2026 on November 5. Chapter 4 proposes CAD 76 million in total from 2027–28 through 2030–31 for Environment and Climate Change Canada, the National Research Council and Fisheries and Oceans Canada. The line item covers regulatory development and implementation, data collection, scientific research and support for the Ghost Gear Program. Annex 3 proposes a new part of the Fisheries Act covering retrieval, possession, management, transport and disposal of abandoned, lost or discarded fishing gear in Canadian fisheries waters. Both are budget proposals. Finance Canada release · Budget 2026, Chapter 4 · Annex 3

For municipal budgets, the proposed departmental total provides no basis for booking local grant revenue. ECCC still posts its separate Federal Plastics Registry maintenance advisory without a restoration date. Portal access remains unverified. Federal Plastics Registry

Ontario · UPDATED Bill 140 process and ONGOING consultations

The Legislative Assembly records second reading and referral to the Standing Committee on the Interior on November 2, before this edition's window. The oral presentation registration deadline passed on November 6. The committee lists a November 17 hearing and accepts written submissions until 6 p.m. Eastern Standard Time that day. Schedule 22 proposes broader authority to regulate agreements under the Resource Recovery and Circular Economy Act, including provision for regulations to reach existing agreements. The Environmental Registry's companion proposal discusses potential Blue Box fee and contract rules. Comments there are due November 26 at 11:59 p.m., as posted. The bill remains at committee stage and the registry options remain proposals. Bill 140, status and Schedule 22 · Committee notice · Environmental Registry

RPRA's October 2 consultation has its own November 16 deadline. Its two drafts address third-party verification of management performance reports and annual reporting of Blue Box supply. Producers, processors and producer responsibility organizations can use this process to flag where weight records or supporting documentation would be hard to reconcile. Keep records of material supplied separate from records supporting recovered-resource weights. The documents remain drafts. RPRA consultation

British Columbia · UPDATED battery-plan consultation calendar

Call2Recycle's schedule listed the first webinar on November 10 and further sessions on November 12, 16 and 18. The proposed additions cover vapes and e-cigarettes, 12-volt batteries and portable power. Written feedback is due December 8. Operators can use the consultation to ask how sites would be equipped, who would collect the new materials and how pickup would be funded. This is an amended-plan consultation. Use the registration and consultation pages to confirm times before participating. Call2Recycle consultation

Program and municipal operations

Alberta · UPDATED commercial paint collection calendar

ARMA scheduled a commercial paint roundup at Renue Recycling in Calgary on November 10. The next scheduled roundup is at Shepard Landfill on November 24. The event is free for qualifying paint-program items in original containers from 100 mL to 23 L. ARMA says some products, including two-component paints, are ineligible and delivery drivers must wait for load inspection. At Shepard, material acceptance ends at 1:45 p.m. This is a route for qualifying business and commercial painter materials under paint stewardship. Municipal staff can direct commercial paint inquiries there and handle residential packaging inquiries through the appropriate local service. The listings establish the schedule and eligibility, with no measured November 10 intake reported. Renue event · Shepard event

Saskatchewan · ONGOING residential collection procurement

SK Recycles still lists November 2026 as the expected selection and announcement window for program-led Phase 2 collection providers, with February 1, 2028 as the service commencement date. The operator also lists December 1, 2026 as the final planned community-led Phase 2 launch date. The published timetable

names no successful bidders. Municipalities should use the schedule that corresponds to their delivery model when planning resident communications and contract transitions. SK Recycles Phase 2 timetable

Quebec · NEW deposit-return site in Saint-Sauveur

On November 11, AQRCB/Consignaction announced the opening of a return site at 191 chemin du Lac-Millette in the Laurentides. It serves deposit-bearing beverage containers, with single-item returns and express bag drop-off. Express refunds are electronic after sorting and counting. Local service guides can direct residents to the site for eligible containers. The operator's announcement gives service details but no measured return volume. Consignaction opening notice

Infrastructure, end markets and funding

British Columbia · NEW partner-based commercial expansion

In its November 6 release, Salish Soils describes an expansion into Greater Vancouver using existing regional infrastructure and partners such as AJM Disposal and West Creek Farms. Its offering includes green and wood waste removal, construction and demolition services, and bulk soil, mulch and aggregates. The company describes a service expansion without a standalone plant. It provides no measured Lower Mainland throughput, product sales or emissions results. Procurement teams assessing the service can ask bidders to identify receiving facilities by material stream and document where the material actually goes. Salish Soils release

Ottawa · NEW consultation on residual disposal options

The city opened consultation November 9 on landfilling and waste-to-energy incineration for garbage remaining after prevention, reuse, recycling and composting. Ottawa says it has secured additional landfill capacity and has yet to decide whether to pursue incineration. The survey closes December 14. For disposal planning, compare alternatives using residual tonnage after diversion and verify the treatment and disposal of remaining residues. The city is still gathering input ahead of future planning and Council decisions. City announcement · Engage Ottawa

National · UPDATED milestone for circular-economy research procurement

The Circular Innovation Council's RFP lists October 30 as its issue date, November 10 as the question deadline, and November 30 at 5 p.m. Eastern as the proposal close. The first stage starts with packaging and printed paper EPR and deposit-return systems. Bidders must explain how they would avoid counting the same activity through producer fees, processor revenues and material sales. The RFP calls for material-flow data where needed to validate economic activity. These are study specifications. Future estimates will depend on final scope and data quality. CIC RFP, sections 3–5 and 14

Upcoming dates

Date	Decision or deadline
November 12, 16 and 18	Remaining BC amended battery-plan webinars listed by the operator. Call2Recycle
November 13, 4:30 p.m. NST	Newfoundland and Labrador Community Waste Diversion Fund applications. This previously reported call offers eligible municipalities, Indigenous community governments and local service districts up to 80% of eligible costs, capped at CAD 25,000. Provincial announcement · MMSB guidelines, section 11.1
November 16	Ontario draft Blue Box audit and supply guidance comments close. RPRA
November 17, 6 p.m. EST	Written submissions to the Ontario Bill 140 committee close. Committee notice
November 24, 1:45 p.m. local	Material acceptance cutoff for Calgary's Shepard commercial paint roundup. ARMA
November 26, 11:59 p.m. as posted	Ontario Blue Box policy consultation closes. Environmental Registry
November 30, 5 p.m. Eastern	Circular Innovation Council proposals due. RFP
December 1	Final planned Phase 2 community-led launch in Saskatchewan. SK Recycles
December 8	Written feedback due on BC's amended battery plan. Call2Recycle
December 14	Ottawa residual waste survey closes. Engage Ottawa

What to watch next

- **Western municipal operations.** Watch for Saskatchewan award notices and confirmation of transition dates. For Wood Buffalo, seek route-level confirmation of collection after the delay covered in the previous edition. SK Recycles · Circular Materials Wood Buffalo service page
- **Federal and Ontario implementation.** Watch for appropriation and legislative details on plastics and fishing gear, an official Federal Plastics Registry restoration notice, and any adopted Ontario Blue Box changes that affect agreements or service. Budget 2026, Annex 3 · Federal Plastics Registry · Environmental Registry
- **Operating evidence.** Request quantities by reporting period, material and destination, with separate totals for supply, collection, verified recycling, inventory and disposal. Keep commercial, institutional and tourism waste separate from residential program totals.

This edition draws on selected federal and provincial records, municipal notices, stewardship schedules and

operator announcements. The sources establish the proposals, schedules and services described. They provide no basis for a new commissioned-capacity estimate, recycling-rate comparison or end-market sales estimate.